

verseatile

Easily set poetry.

v.0.2.2

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verseatile is a small package for setting poetry with Typst, capable of easily indenting and numbering verses while providing many options for customization.

This manual was set from
the  Garamontio typeface
on 110 × 165 mm paper
using tschich for proportions.

I. Setting poems

I.1. Getting Started

To print a poem simply use:

```
#poem[poemtitle][  
  poembody]
```

Inside the `<poembody>` the end of a verse must be marked by a linebreak (“\”) while the end of a stanza is marked by an empty line following its last verse.

See  *Example 1*.

I.2. Inline poemtitles

A part of the first verse can be set as an inline poemtitle using:

```
#inline-poemtitle[part-of-verse]
```

II. Configuring indentation

II.1. Overhang of long verses

If a verse is longer than a single line on the paper its overhang can be ragged left below (without affecting verse numbering) by preceding it with:

```
#overhang(mark: none)
```

Additionally a `<mark>` can be specified that is placed in front of the overhang.

See  *Example 2*.

II.2. Indentpatterns

An `<indentpattern>` specifies how the verses of the `<poembody>` for a given poem are to be indented. It can be added as a third argument when using:

```
#poem[poemtitle][  
  poembody][..indentpattern]
```

The `<indentpattern>` consist of a series of numbers demarking the level of indentation and is repeatedly applied. With every level (starting from zero) the verse is incrementally indented by the same space, such that the pattern for alternating indentation would be `[01]` etc.

See  *Example 3*.

II.3. Indentation and spacing options

The values for indentation and spacing of the `<poemtitle>` can be controlled by using:

```
#poem-options(  
  indents: (base: 1em, verse: 1em, stanza: 0em),  
  poemtitle: (clearance: 20em/11, always-align: false))
```

For indents the `<base-indent>` (Default: 1em) determines the length by which all verses on the base level (zero) are indented. The `<verse-indent>` (Default: 1em) determines the length added to this with each increasing level of indentation. The `<stanza-indent>` (Default: 0em) determines the length added to the indent of the first verse of each stanza.

For the `<poemtitle>` the `<clearance>` (Default: 20em/11) determines its distance to the `<poembody>`. If `<always-align>` (Default: false) is toggled, the first verse will by default be printed at the same height that it would have been, if there was a normal (one line) `<poemtitle>`.

III. Setting cycles

Cycles of multiple poems can be printed by using:

```
#cycle[cycletitle][..cyclesubtitle][  
  cyclebody])
```

Cycles can be given a subtitle as a second argument that is rendered directly behind the `<cycletitle>` by default. The poems belonging to the cycle are then printed inside the `<cyclebody>` by using:

```
#poem-incycle[poemtitle][..poemsubtitle][  
  poembody][indentpattern])
```

Note that for poems in cycles an `<indentpattern>` must be specified. They can also be given a subtitle as a second argument that is rendered behind the `<poemtitle>` by default.

See  *Example 4*.

IV. Numbering verses

Verse numbers can be displayed by using:

```
#verse-numbering(true)
```

They are placed at a configurable $\langle\text{distance}\rangle$ from the leftmost border of the $\langle\text{poembody}\rangle$. By default verse numbers $\langle\text{start}\rangle$ at one with $\langle\text{modulo}\rangle$ one, such that every verse number is being displayed. The options can be configured by using:

```
#verse-numbering(start: 1, modulo: 1, distance: 5em/11)
```

See  *Example 5*.

V. Adding special elements

V.1. Interjections

Interjections can be placed at any point in the `<poembody>` while not being counted as verses by using:

```
#interjection(interjectionbody)
```

They must either be separated from the preceding and following verse with an empty line or be followed by a linebreak (“\”) when placed directly in between two verses and are rendered with normal spacing.

See  *Example 6*.

V.2. Dedications

Dedications work very similar to interjections and can be inserted by using:

```
#dedication(dedicationbody)
```

They must be placed at the beginning of the `<poembody>` and will be rendered with appropriate spacing in relation to the `<poemtitle>`. Dedications can also be added to a cycle as a whole by beginning the `<cyclebody>` by using:

```
#dedication-ofcycle(dedicationbody)
```

See  *Example 7*.

VI. Splitting verses

Single verses can be split over multiple lines, such that the following part is always indented to the length of its predecessor without affecting verse numbering. To split a verse into two parts, its first part must be wrapped by:

```
#splitverse[part-of-verse]
```

The second part must then be preceded by calling:

```
#versesplit
```

To split a verse into more than two parts, every part before the last must be wrapped with `#splitverse[]` and only the last part be preceded by `#versesplit`. Linebreaks (“\”) must only ever be placed at the very end of the verse.

See  *Example 8*.

VII. Using presets

Presets are preconfigured style sets that can be used for simple and effective styling. A preset can be applied by using:

#show: preset-name

See  *Example 9*.

VII.1. Available presets

As of v.0.2.2 the package includes the following presets:

classic	
	CYCLETITLE Cyclesubtitle
	POEMTITLE-INCYCLE <i>Poemsubtitle-incycle</i>
1	Numbered-verse
	<i>INTERJECTION</i>
2	Numbered-verse
	POEMTITLE
	<i>Dedication</i>
1	INLINE-POEMTITLE rest-of-verse

elegant

Cycletitle Cyclesubtitle

POEMTITLE-INCYCLE *Poemsubtitle-incycle*

1 Numbered-verse

INTERJECTION

2 Numbered-verse

Poemtitle

Dedication

1 *Inline-poemtitle* rest-of-verse

VII.2. Heading variants of *presets*

Calling `#show: preset-name-headings` instead, preserves most of the preset's configurations but renders the titles of poems and cycles being as second- and titles of poems in cycles being rendered as third-level headings. This can especially be useful for outlining poems.

VIII. Customizing styling options

As most elements of the poem or cycle are labeled their styling can be free customized using show rules. As of v.0.2.2 this includes the following elements: <poemtitle>, <inline-poemtitle>, <cycletitle>, <cyclesubtitle>, <poemtitle-incycle>, <poemsubtitle-incycle>, <dedication>, <interjection> and <verse-number>.

See  *Example 10*.

IX. Examples

Example 1. Simply printing a poem.

```
#poem[Hor. carm. I, 26][  
Musis amicus tristitiam et metus \  
tradam protervis in mare Creticum \  
portare ventis, quis sub Arcto \  
rex gelidae metuatur orae,  
  
quid Tiridaten terreat, unice \  
securus. O quae fontibus integris \  
gaudes, apricos nocte flores, \  
nocte meo Lamiae coronam, #sym.dots]
```

Hor. carm. I, 26

Musis amicus tristitiam et metus
tradam protervis in mare Creticum
portare ventis, quis sub Arcto
rex gelidae metuatur orae,

quid Tiridaten terreat, unice
securus. O quae fontibus integris
gaudes, apricos nocte flores,
nocte meo Lamiae coronam, ...

Back to  Section I.1.

Example 2. Manually adjusting the overhang of a long verse.

```
#poem[Cat. carm. 76][  
#sym.dots \  
nam quaecumque homines bene cuiquam aut dicere  
#overhang(mark: sym.floor.l) possunt. \  
aut facere, haec a te dictaque factaque sunt: \  
#sym.dots]
```

Cat. carm. 76

...
nam quaecumque homines bene cuiquam aut dicere
| possunt.
aut facere, haec a te dictaque factaque sunt:
...

Back to  Section II.1.

Example 3. Using an indentpattern to indent every third line once and every fourth line twice.

```
#poem[Hor. carm. I, 26][  
  Musis amicus tristitiam et metus \  
  tradam protervis in mare Creticum \  
  portare ventis, quis sub Arcto \  
  rex gelidae metuatur orae,  
  
  quid Tiridaten terreat, unice \  
  securus. O quae fontibus integris \  
  gaudes, apricos necte flores, \  
  necte meo Lamiae coronam, #sym.dots  
][0012]
```

Hor. carm. I, 26

Musis amicus tristitiam et metus
tradam protervis in mare Creticum
portare ventis, quis sub Arcto
rex gelidae metuatur orae,

quid Tiridaten terreat, unice
securus. O quae fontibus integris
gaudes, apricos necte flores,
necte meo Lamiae coronam, ...

Back to  Section II.2.

Example 4. Printing a cycle of poems.

#cycle[Martialis epigrammata][(XIV, 45 ff.)][

#poem-incycle[XLV.][Pila paganica][

Haec quae difficili turget paganica pluma, \

Folle minus laxast et minus arta pila.

][01]

#poem-incycle[XLVI.][Pila trigonalis][

Si me nobilibus scis expulsare sinistris, \

Sum tua. Tu nescis? rustice, redde pilam.

][01]

#poem-incycle[XLVII.][Follis][

Ite procul, iuvenes: mitis mihi convenit aetas: \

Folle decet pueros ludere, folle senes.

][01]]

Example 4. Printing a cycle of poems.

Martialis epigrammata (XIV, 45 ff.)

XLV. Pila paganica

Haec quae difficili turget paganica pluma,
Folle minus laxast et minus arta pila.

XLVI. Pila trigonalis

Si me nobilibus scis expulsare sinistris,
Sum tua. Tu nescis? rustice, redde pilam.

XLVII. Follis

Ite procul, iuvenes: mitis mihi convenit aetas:
Folle decet pueros ludere, folle senes.

Back to  Section III.

Example 5. Numbering every second verse.

```
#verse-numbering(true, modulo: 2)
```

```
#poem[Hor. carm. I, 26][
```

```
Musis amicus tristitiam et metus \  
tradam protervis in mare Creticum \  
portare ventis, quis sub Arcto \  
rex gelidae metuatur orae,
```

```
quid Tiridaten terreat, unice \  
securus. O quae fontibus integris \  
gaudes, apricos necte flores, \  
necte meo Lamiae coronam, #sym.dots
```

```
][0012]
```

Hor. carm. I, 26

```
      Musis amicus tristitiam et metus  
2 tradam protervis in mare Creticum  
      portare ventis, quis sub Arcto  
4      rex gelidae metuatur orae,  
  
      quid Tiridaten terreat, unice  
6 securus. O quae fontibus integris  
      gaudes, apricos necte flores,  
8      necte meo Lamiae coronam, ...
```

Back to  Section IV.

Example 6. Using interjections to mark strophes and antistrophes.

#verse-numbering(true, start: 176, modulo: 2)

#poem[Aischyl. Ag. 176--191][

#interjection[στυ. γ.]

τὸν φρονεῖν βροτουὶ ὁδῶ- \
σαντα, τὸν πάθει μάθος \
θέντα κυρίως ἔχειν. \
στάζει δ' ἐν θ' ὕπνῳ προῖκα καρδίας \
μνησιπήμων πόνος· καὶ παρ' ἄ- \
κοντας ἦλθε σωφρονεῖν. \
δαιμόνων δέ που χάρις βίαιος \
σέλμα σεμνὸν ἡμένων.

#interjection[ἀντ. γ.]

καὶ τόθ' ἡγεμὼν ὁ πρέ- \
σβυς νεῶν Ἀχαιικῶν, \
μάντιν οὔτινα ψέγων, \
ἐμπαίοις τύχαισι συμπνέων, \
εὖτ' ἀπλοῖα κεναγγεῖ βαρύ- \
νοντ' Ἀχαιικὸς λεώς, \
Χαλκίδος πέραν ἔχων παλιρρόχ- \
θοις ἐν Αὐλίδος τόποις·

][0]

Example 6. Using interjections to mark strophes and antistrophes.

Aischyl. Ag. 176–191

στρ. γ.

- 176 τὸν φρονεῖν βροτοὺς ὁδῶ-
σαντα, τὸν πάθει μάθος
178 θέντα κυρίως ἔχειν.
στάζει δ' ἐν θ' ὕπνῳ πρὸ καρδίας
180 μνησιπήμων πόνος· καὶ παρ' ἄ-
κοντας ἦλθε σωφρονεῖν.
182 δαιμόνων δέ που χάρις βίαιος
σέλμα σεμνὸν ἡμένων.

ἀντ. γ.

- 184 καὶ τόθ' ἡγεμῶν ὁ πρέ-
σβυς νεῶν Ἀχαικῶν,
186 μάντιν οὐτίνα ψέγων,
ἐμπαίοις τύχαισι συμπνέων,
188 εὖτ' ἀπλοῖα κεναγγεῖ βαρύ-
νοντ' Ἀχαικὸς λεώς,
190 Χαλκίδος πέραν ἔχων παλιρρόχ-
θοις ἐν Αὐλίδος τόποις·
-

Back to  Section V.I.

Example 7. Adding a dedication to a poem.

```
#poem[Cat. carm. 1][  
#dedication[ad Cornelium]  
  
Cui dono lepidum novum libellum \  
arido modo pumice expositum? \  
Corneli, tibi; namque tu solebas \  
meas esse aliquid putare nugas, \  
iam tum cum ausus es unus Italorum \  
omne aevum tribus explicare chartis, \  
doctis, Iuppiter, et laboriosis! \  
#sym.dots]
```

Cat. carm. 1

ad Cornelium

Cui dono lepidum novum libellum
arido modo pumice expositum?
Corneli, tibi; namque tu solebas
meas esse aliquid putare nugas,
iam tum cum ausus es unus Italorum
omne aevum tribus explicare chartis,
doctis, Iuppiter, et laboriosis!

...

Back to  Section V.2.

Example 8. Splitting a verse into three parts.

```
#verse-numbering(true)

#poem[Cat. carm. 85][
  #splitverse[Odi et amo.]
  #splitverse[quare id faciam,]
  #versesplit fortasse requiris.
  nescio, sed fieri sentio et excrucior.
][01]
```

Cat. carm. 85

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1 | Odi et amo.
quare id faciam,
fortasse requiris. |
| 2 | nescio, sed fieri sentio et excrucior. |
-

Back to  Section VI.

Example 9. Using the classic-preset to style a cycle.

#show: preset-classic

#cycle[Martialis epigrammata][(XIV, 45 ff.)][

#poem-incycle[XLV.][Pila paganica][

Haec quae difficili turget paganica pluma, \

Folle minus laxast et minus arta pila.

][01]

#poem-incycle[XLVI.][Pila trigonalis][

Si me nobiles scis expulsare sinistris, \

Sum tua. Tu nescis? rustice, redde pilam.

][01]

#poem-incycle[XLVII.][Follis][

Ite procul, iuvenes: mitis mihi convenit aetas: \

Folle decet pueros ludere, folle senes.

][01]]

Example 9. Using the classic-preset to style a cycle.

MARTIALIS EPIGRAMMATA (XIV, 45 ff.)

XLV. *Pila paganica*

Haec quae difficili turget paganica pluma,
Folle minus laxast et minus arta pila.

XLVI. *Pila trigonalis*

Si me nobilibus scis expulsare sinistris,
Sum tua. Tu nescis? rustice, redde pilam.

XLVII. *Follis*

Ite procul, iuvenes: mitis mihi convenit aetas:
Folle decet pueros ludere, folle senes.

Back to  Section VII.

Example 10. Styling the poemtitle (as it is shown with the classic-preset).

```
#show <poemtitle>: it => text(  
  size: 14em/11,  
  tracking: 0.25pt,  
  number-type: "old-style",  
  number-width: "proportional"  
)[#smallcaps(it)]  
  
#poem[Cat. carm. 85][  
  Odi et amo. quare id faciam, fortasse requiris. \  
  nescio, sed fieri sentio et excrucior.  
][01]
```

CAT. CARM. 85

Odi et amo. quare id faciam, fortasse requiris.
nescio, sed fieri sentio et excrucior.

Back to  Section VIII.

X. Changelog

V.O.2.2

Backward compatibility: All older versions (v.o.1.0 – v.o.2.1).

Note the syntax changes for splitting verses!

- New features:
- Added functionality for more easily controlling options for indents, spacing and verse numbers via `#poem-options()` and `#verse-numbering()`.
 - Added functionality for handling overhang of long verses via `#overhang()`.
 - Added functionality for manually suppressing verse numbers via labeling verses with `<do-not-number>`.
 - Added dedications for cycles.
- Presets:
- Added presets (elegant, elegant-headings).
- Fixes:
- Completely rewrote the code for constructing the poembody introducing a modular tagging system.
 - Prevented issues with verse numbers when splitting verses over multiple stanzas.
 - Prevented issues with indentation when using stanza indents.
 - Made it obsolete to start or end the poembody with an empty line.
 - Made it optional to specify an indentpattern when using `#poem[[]]`.
- Documentation:
- Overhauled the manual.

V.O.2.1

Backward compatibility: All older versions (v.o.1.0 – v.o.2.0).

Fixes:

- Prevented issues with interjections / split verses and verse numbers caused by the re-structured code.

Documentation:

- Updated the manual.

V.O.2.0

Backward compatibility: All older versions (v.o.1.0 – v.o.1.1).

- New features:
- Added presets.
 - Added interjections and dedications.
 - Added functionality to split verses via `#splitverse[]` and `#versesplit`.
 - Added subtitles for cycles and poems in cycles.
 - Made the indentation of the first verse of a stanza configurable via `#stanza-indent.update()`.
 - Made the starting verse number configurable via `#verse-numbers-start.update()`.
- Presets:
- Added presets (classic, classic-headings).
- Fixes:
- Reworked inline poemtitles to prevent false headings being displayed in the outline in certain constellations.
 - Restructured and commented the code.
- Documentation:
- Updated the manual.
 - Updated the readme.

V.O.I.I

Backward compatibility: All older versions (v.o.i.o).

New features:

- Made the distance between verse numbers and the poem configurable via `#verse-number-distance.update()`.

Fixes:

- Reworked verse numbers to prevent them causing issues with indentation in certain constellations.

Documentation:

- Updated the manual.

V.O.I.O

Initial release.